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Write an ending to the case study that synthesizes your knowledge of the change process, knowledge of instructional design, and details given within the case.

For a long time, academic freedom has been considered a privilege that teachers and educators alike take pride in in their teaching profession. They just do not like being told how to manage their classroom or how to teach students in it. However, teachers are expected to continually improve their teaching approaches. In addition, there should be some guidelines for measuring and evaluating learning.

According to the two articles below, team teaching is considered the education of the future. Team-taught courses have not only become an important part of the Stanford curriculum, but many other K-12 schools and colleges are exploring collaborative teaching. This kind of teaching is a form of co-teaching in which two or more teachers team-teach, working together on curriculum content and organization, as well as on training methods.

Case study 3 focuses on identifying ways to improve teaching and learning at Thompson Run Elementary School. More importantly, it is about how to get teachers working together. This is a challenge for the Principal, Shannon Ensman; good relationships among teachers are key to the success of instructional design at Thompson Run Elementary School.

Given the situation at Thompson Run Elementary School, Shannon first needs to improve the working relationship among teachers. She knows that overnight, she can't just force all the teachers to embrace the new ways of teaching. Even though Carla Fox seems to be a good candidate for this effort, she needs to reconsider offering her the lead position on the new instructional materials. The foremost reason is that she is still very new at the school and not well recognized as a respectable instructional designer by her colleagues. She may have done well teaching her class, and her students may perform well, but this is not the kind of experience needed to make school-wide changes to instructional materials and to work with other teachers.

I think Carla is a good teacher, which is a good reason to promote her. In a team environment, Carla's promotion is bound to cause conflict. I think that Shannon should have given all the other teachers a role in the new ways of teaching and given Carla a role in what she does best. Shannon needs to have one-on-one talks with all the teachers first before the staff meeting. A staff meeting is no place to discuss new strategies and brainstorm. Shannon should have done better planning and informed other teachers about her intention before the meeting.

This is team teaching, or rather collaborative teaching, and the successful development of new instructional materials depends on the participation of all teachers, who need to work together.

I. Shafer (2001), Team Teaching: Education for the Future from
<http://www.usao.edu/~facshaferi/teamteaching.htm>

M. C. Leavitt (2006), Team Teaching: Benefits and Challenges from
<http://ctl.stanford.edu/Newsletter/teamteaching.pdf>

Cornell University (1997), Cornell University Teaching Evaluation Handbook from
<http://www.clt.cornell.edu/resources/teh/ch2.html>

Perri Response:

A staff meeting is no place to discuss new strategy and brainstorming.

I agree, and unfortunately, what has evolved to replace this once-central event in the lives of teachers is not as predictable or complete, somehow. Nonetheless, if the energy that comes from collaboration on the one-to-one level leads to more "strategy and brainstorming" than on the school-wide level, then that can't be a bad thing. The tricky thing remains funding and accountability.

Dr. Butler response:
Week 3 Feedback:

Hi Jim,

Well done in week 3 exploring key issues with instructional design. In your W3 Deliverable, I enjoyed reading what you wrote here:

I think Carla is a good teacher and, furthermore, will do well as an instructional designer. Maybe it is just too early to promote Carla. In a team environment, Carla's promotion is bound to cause conflict. I think that Shannon should have given all the other teachers a role playing in the new ways of teaching and given Carla a role in what she does best. Shannon needs to have one-on-one talks with all the teachers before the staff meeting and provide as much information as possible about her intention. A staff meeting is no place to discuss new strategies and brainstorm. Shannon should have done better planning and informed other teachers about her intention before the meeting.

I agree with you fully on the following points:

1. Carla's promotion may cause conflict because of her relative newness with the situation.
2. Shannon should have talked to key players individually before the staff meeting.
3. Bring additional teachers on board for the team to help with buy-in and to improve the content of the instruction because who knows better what is going on in the classroom than the teachers? These teachers can provide insight to help address unforeseen challenges in instruction.

4. Shannon should have done better with her planning and let the teachers know exactly what her intentions were before the meeting. Nothing worse than being blindsided by a new policy coming down which teachers didn't have a voice in.

I very much enjoyed what you wrote here in your Week 3 DB C response:

If you work in a project team before, then you may be familiar with these activities that are the project development lifecycle. The project development lifecycle is multi-disciplinary organizational efforts often involving a lot of people inside and outside the group and it calls for different skills and people at different times. The issues and challenges start off numerous and evolve throughout the project.

I like how well you described the complexities involved with an instructional design team. I especially like how you emphasized that importance that an effective project development is multi-disciplinary in nature.

Another great week Jim! Thanks for your hard work.

Kind regards,

Kim